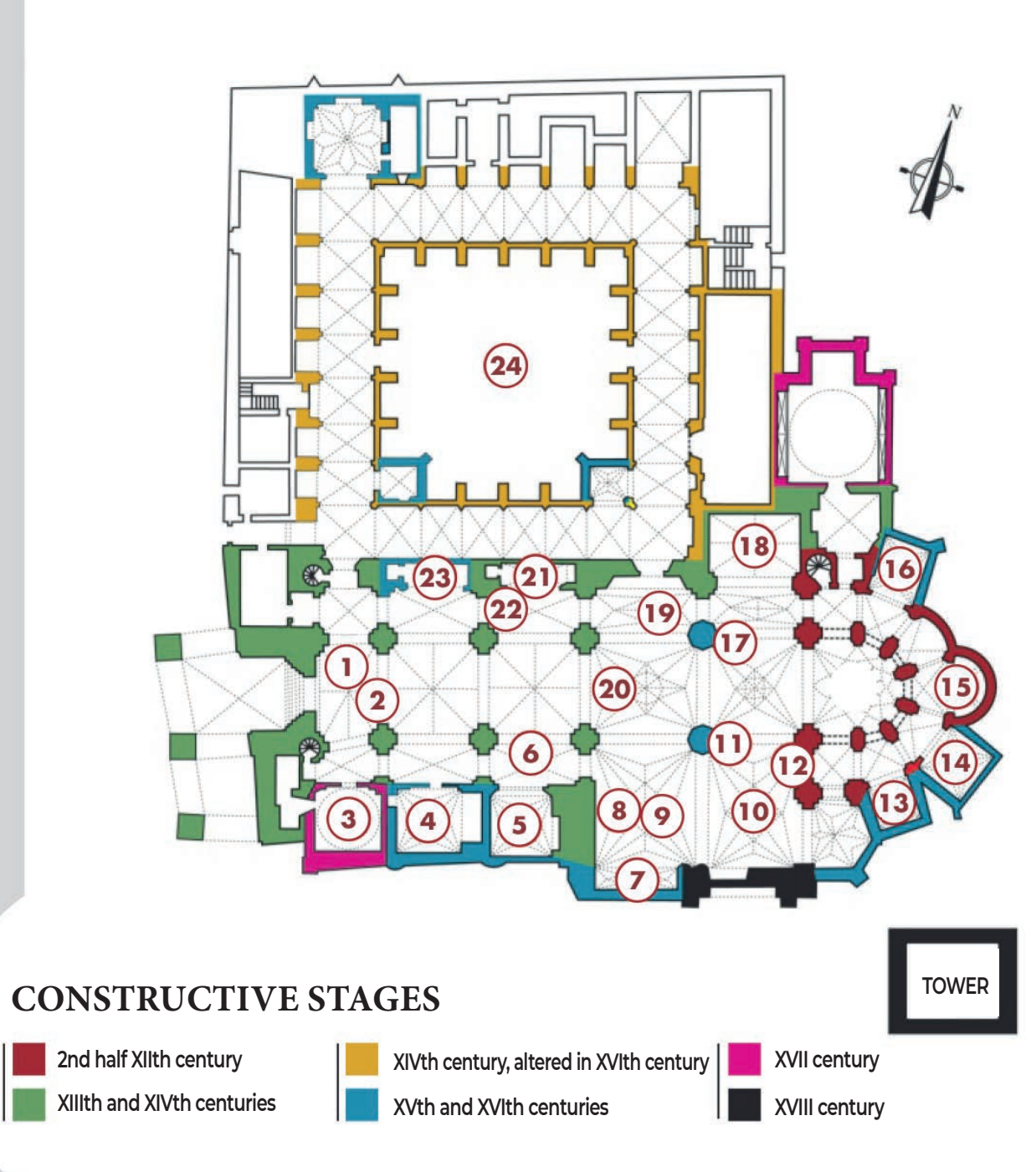
Catedral Guide

HISTORY

From its beginnings Santo Domingo de la Calzada has always been linked to The Pilgrimage of St. James. lts founder, Domingo García, was born in Viloria de Rioja (Burgos) in 1019. He decided to devote his life to God and tried to enter the monasteries of San Millán and Valvanera but was not accepted. Around the year 1040 he became a hermit in the forests which occupied the site on which this city now stands. From his home he was able to see how difficult the pilgrimage was for those undertaking it and he began to work to help them by building a bridge to cross the Oja River, a hospital where pilgrims could seek refuge, roads communicating Nájera and Redecilla del Camino (Burgos) and a little church. Domingo received approval from Alfonso VI de Castilla who provided the piece of land where Domingo built the first church completed in 1106, but which sadly no longer exists. When he died, on 12th May 1109, he was buried in the middle of the Pilgrimage, which he had designed. His followers maintained the little village which la ter took his name and they continued his work, creating a confraternity, which nowadays works keeping his memories, traditions and beliefs alive by working with pilgrims in the Hostel.

STAGES OF THE CONSTRUCTION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TOWER
CONSTRUCTIVE STAGES
2nd half XIIth century
XIIIth and XIVth centuries
XIVth century, altered in XVIth century
XVth and XVIth centuries
XVII century
XVIII century

DESCRIPTION

The plant, a Latin cross, is essentialy Romanesque. The long arms (main nave) is 62 m long. The cruise, 31 m wide. Since its heigh of 25 m. The right arm was extended, by way of living, to houre the tomb of the Saint and his Chapel.

1.- Paintings of the Retrochoir

Great peintings on wood by Alonso Gallego and Andres de Melgar with three scenes of the Passion.

Parish baptismal font where Saint Jeronimo Hermosilla was baptized onOctober 4th , 1800.

3.- Chapel of the Saint John the Bautist or of Saint Theresa

Founded by D. Pedro Xuarez de Figueroa. ***Embossed iron fence*** from 16th century. ***Altarpiece*** with 24 hispano-flamencas pictures and 9 sculptures. ***Sepulchre of the founder,*** with the coat of arms of the family around the tomb. ***Monds of statues*** from the 15th and 16th centuries. At the front arcosolia, ***wall paintings*** from the 15th century.

4-5.- Chapel of Hermosilla and Tables of Santo Domingo (of miracles)

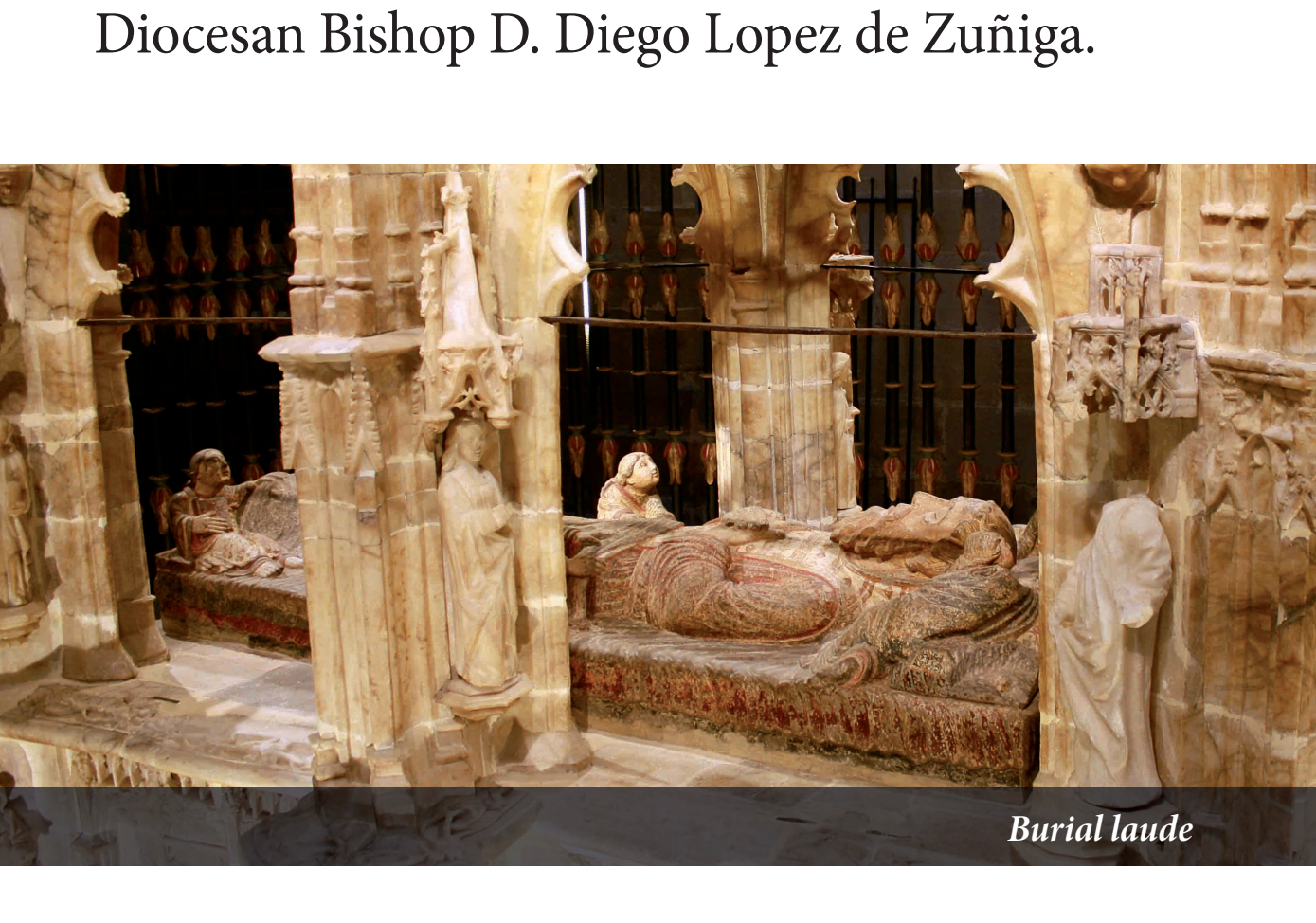
Founded by Diocesan Bishop D. Diego Lopez de Zuniga on the 15th century, is currently dedicated to Saint Jeronimo Hermosilla. Bom in this city (Santo Domingo de la Calzada) in 1800 and martyred in Tonkin (Vietnam) on november 1st, 1861. ***The altarpiece,*** the work of Diego de Ichaso and dates from 1653. In niches on the wall, his relics and the chains with which it was led to martyrdom.

Nine pictures: made by Alonso Gallego and Andres de Melgar from the 16th century, narando episodes from the life of Saint Domingo. Central:- The Saint accompanied by captives freed by his intercesion. From the left to the right, from the top: -Santi's hands releasing the city from the cruel siege Peter l;- Miracle of hanged;- The cock and hen leaped from the plate after beeing roasted(resurrected) ;- The healing of the pastor from Ayuela;- The resurrection of the pilgrim hit by a car.- The dog that brings the hand that had offended the Holy.Santo Domingo pushed on fire and beaten.- Dealing charity.

7-8.- Mausoleum with crypt pf the Saint and the henhouse

Mausoleum: With the ***image*** of Saint Domingo, work by Julian de San Martin in 1789.

Recumbent statue of 2 m high, one of the few and the best example of Spanish-Romanesque sculpture and polychrome of the late 12th century. An ***alabaster*** shrine Florid Gothic temple designed by Felipe de Vigamy- The Burgundy, in 1513. Burial box made around 1450 with various miracles from the life of the Saint around it, ordered built by the Diocesan Bishop D. Diego Lopez de Zuñiga.



Burial laude

Crypt: A reliquary tomb (tomb shrine) with "Carpo Santo" of the Founder, sponsored by the Ministry of Public Works in 1958.

Crypt of the Saint

Henhouse: henhouse of stone guarried from the late Gotic of (1445), with a live cock and hen, always wite, a perpetual reminder of the miracle of the pilgrim unjustly hanged. Are cared by the Cofratemity of The Holy and changed every 15 days.

Above the niche is preserved a pice of wood from the galows, and on the front door, a peinting of the 16 century work of Andres de Melgar, tells their time of hanging.

On the left, shackles offered by captives as votive offerings.

(At the end of this guide is the story of the Miracle).

Gothic henhouse with a pair of alive hen and rooster

11.- Chapel of Saint James

This chapel was founded in the first half of the 16th century by the master Vallejo, Canon of the Cathedral. Altarpiece dedicated to Saint James by the frenchman Mateo Lancrin, around 1560. lmage of Saint Domingo de la Calzada on a bridge.

13.- Romanesque chapel of Saint Peter

The only original Romanesque chapel remains. ***Storied capitals, three arches*** cut by colonettes (mulions) decorated whith the figures of Abraham, Issac andJacob.

On the left side ***capital of the Epiphany*** - with the **gotic sculpture** of Virgin Mary de la Calzada.

14.- Chapel of Saint Bartholemew and of the Blessed

Built around 1545 by the Canon Don Bartolome Paz, now is the Chapel of Santisimo.

Baroque Temple with tabemacle from the 17th century made by Francisco de la Cueva and sculpture of the ***Immaculate Virgin*** from the 18th century by Domingo Elcaraeta. 13th century ***canvas*** copy of the engraving by San Bartholemew de Ribera.

15.- Romanic header

The romanic header is formed by an ***presbytery*** surrounded by eight beautiful pilastres and a ***hallway*** ar aisle that borders. At the top another corridor with windows at the altar. Behind the aisle there are three smaller chapels; the central one, dedicated to Saint Peter, retains its Romanic shape and decoration.

The ***capitals*** at the ends of the aisle is dedicated to the Saviour and St. Mary in the mystery of the Assumption. On the left side of the aisle, ***Christ Pantocrator*** (like Saviour) in the tetramrfos mandarla and procession of angels with symbols of the Passion in his hands. On the right side, capital of the ***Dormition of the Virgen*** (The Assumption - soul being taken to heaven).

16.- Central Altarpiece Chapel

Until 1994 the great Main Altarpiece hid the Romanic header of the Main Chapel. It is the last work of Damian Forment who had made the Altarpiece from the Basílica of Pilar from Zaragoza, the Altarpiece from the Cathedral from Huesca, the Altarpiece from the Monastery of Poblet etc. Damian Forment died three years later, in this city on 24 Decemder 1940.

It has 9 m wide and 13 m high.

The delicate polychrome, work by Andres de Melgar from 1539 to 1551, is fantastic at last detale and it represents on of the greatest jewels of the Spanish Renaissance (121 pictures of bulk walnut, gold, stuffed).

lt has a secular display of omaments made of mytho-logy and grotesques that is not repeated in any Church of Spain.

Renaissance altarpiece, by Damián Forment

18.- Choir

A plateresque work consists 26 low chairs and 33 high chairs. The reliefs of the backs are made by Guillen of Holland. Stresses the central seat of the Bishop, work of Andres de N ajera, with the image of Saint Domingo. The left side was finished in 1525, and the right side was reproduced of the original, after the fire from 1825.

20.- Chapel of Mary Magdelene

Founded by Pedro de Carranza, canon of these Church and Cathedral de Burgos, on the 16th century. ***Altarpiece*** with paintings by Leon Picardo and the image of the Saint Domingo. ***Embosed*** iron gate and plateresque ornaments attributed to the workshop of Andino vault openwork circles. The tomb of the chapel is attributed to The Burgundian with representation of Annunciation.

21.- Medievale Defences

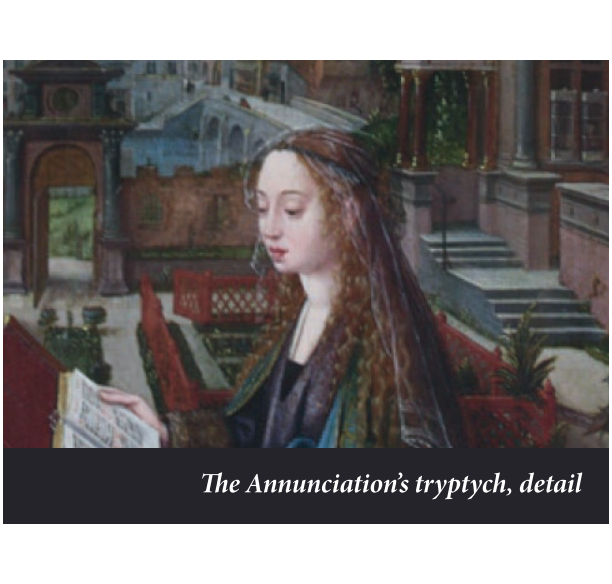
The defensive system of the Cathedral dates from 14th century. You can visit the assembly from passageways and spiral staircases, where you can admire beautiful view of the tower is extempt and the city walls built by King Pedro I of Castile in the 14th century.

22.- Cloister

Sponsored by the Diocensan Bishop D. Juan del Pino in the first half of the 14th century, it has recently been restored and houses the ***permanent exhibition*** of the funds of the Cathedral and temporary exhibitions.

Among the works that are permanently exposed include: Mexican silver pieces from the 17th century; three Flenish triptych: (the Adoration of the Magi, made by a dutch master in 1490, the Mass of Saint Gregory made by Adrian lsenbrandt in 1530, Annunciation, by Joos Van Cleve in 1515-1520), and a Flenish sculpture of the Veronica from the 15th century.

In the east wing of the Cloister, a magnificent Capitulary Hall. Alfaraje late 15th century and ashlar made by Santiago Allana in 1668.



The Annunciation's tryptych, detail

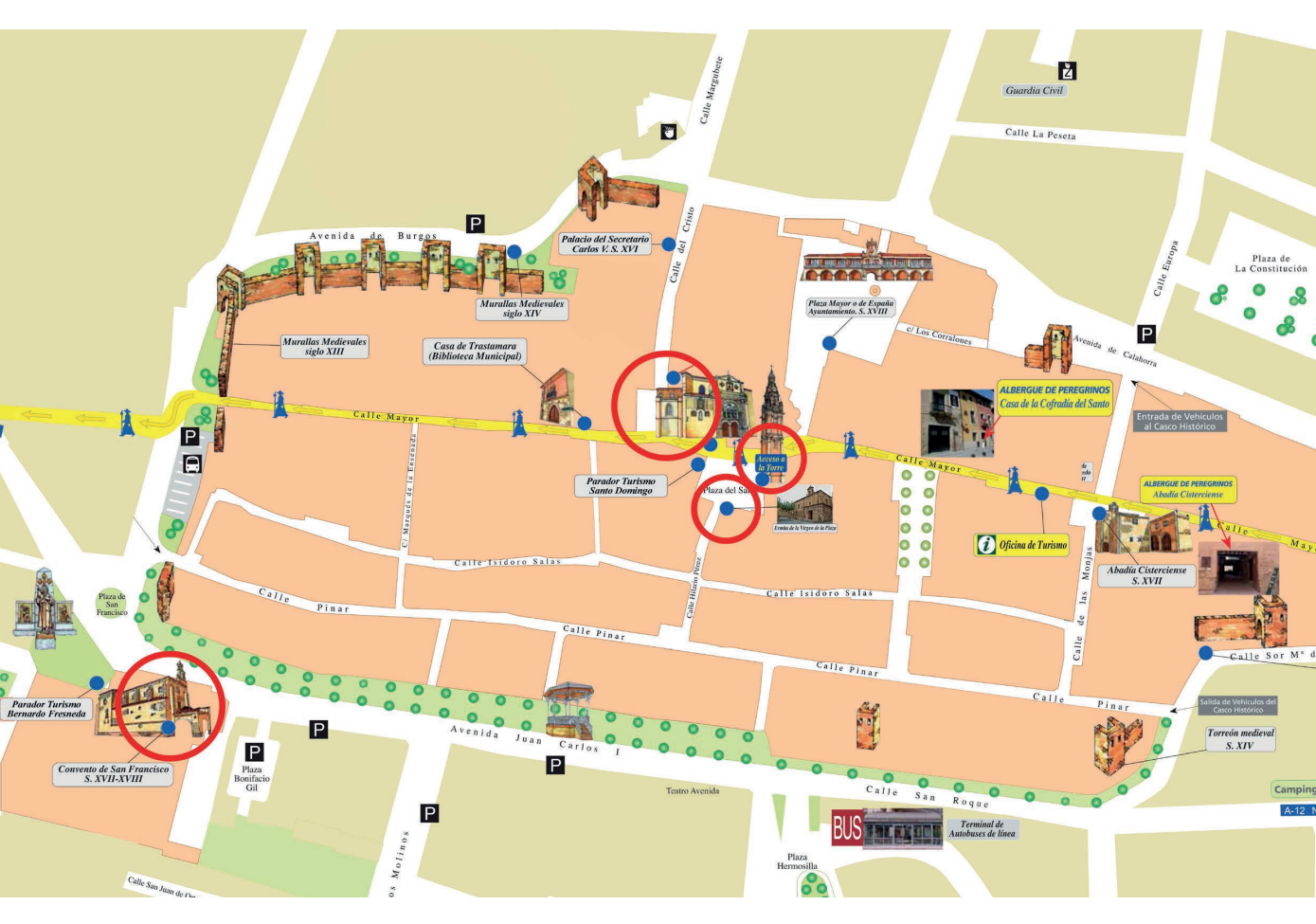
La Verónica, a Spanish-Flemish sculpture

THE HEN AND THE ROOSTER MIRACLE

Legend tells of a German Pilgrim called Hugonell who was walking to Santiago with his parents, when they decided to rest at an inn in Santo Domingo de la Calzada. The owner of the inn's daughter immediately fell in love with him; however her feelings were not reciprocated, so the girl, angered, placed a sil ver cup into his luggage and accused the boy of theft. Thieves at that time were punished by hanging, and this was the fate ofHugonell. His parents, saddened by his death continued the pilgrimage, and upon arriving in Santiago de Compostela, began their return journey to visit the grave of their dead son. When they arrived in Santo Domingo however, they found their son still hanging in the gallows but, miraculously alive. Hugonell, excited, said to them: "Santo Domingo brought back me to life, please go to the Mayor's house and ask him to take me clown".

Quickly, the parents arrived at the Mayor's house and told him of the miracle. The incredulous Mayor, who was preparing to have dinner with friends, responded: "That boy is as alive as these two roast chickens we are about to eat," and suddenly, the chickens carne to life, sprouted feathers and beaks and began to crow, and so, to this day there is a saying about the town which goes:

"Santo Domingo of the Way...
... where the Hen crowed after being roasted!"


Guardia Civil
Calle La Peseta
Calle Margubete
Avenida de Burgos
Palacio del Secretario Carlos V. S. XVI
Calle del Cristo
Plaza de La Constitución
Calle Europa
Murallas Medievales siglo XIV
Plaza Mayor o de España Ayuntamiento. S. XVIII
c/ Los Corralones
Avenida de Calahorra
Murallas Medievales siglo XIII
Casa de Trastamara (Biblioteca Municipal)
ALBERGUE DE PEREGRINOS Casa de la Cofradía del Santo
Entrada de Vehículos al Casco Histórico
Calle Mayor
Parador Turismo Santo Domingo
Plaza del Santo
ALBERGUE DE PEREGRINOS Abadía Cisterciense
Oficina de Turismo
Abadía Cisterciense S. XVII
Calle Isidoro Salas
Calle Pinar
Plaza de San Francisco
Calle Sor Mª de
Salida de Vehículos del Casco Histórico
Parador Turismo Bernardo Fresneda
Convento de San Francisco S. XVII-XVIII
Plaza Bonifacio Gil
Avenida Juan Carlos I
Torreón medieval S. XIV
Teatro Avenida
Calle San Roque
BUS
Terminal de Autobuses de línea
Plaza Hermosilla
Calle San Juan de Or
Camping
A-12

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